Black forest: The lush and dark coloured fig and pine trees give black colour to this region.

3. The Alpine Mountain System:

The alpine mountain system consists of a chain of young fold mountains found in the southern part of Europe. The important mountain ranges are **the Sierra Nevada**, the **Pyrenees, the Alps, the Apennines, the Dinaric Alps, the Caucasus** and **the Carpathian**. The Pyrenees forms a natural boundary between Spain and France.

The highest peak in Europe is **Mt. Elburz** (5645 m) in the Caucasus range. The **Mont Blanc** (4,807 m) found in the Alps is the second highest peak in the Alpine System.



Mont Blanc

There are several active volcanoes found in the Alpine mountain system. **Mt. Etna**, **Mt. Vesuvius** and **Mt. Stromboli** are the important volcanoes found in Europe. Earthquakes are common in this region. The Stromboli is called the '**light house of the Mediterranean**'.

The Matterhorn : The pyramid-shaped Matterhorn mountain is located in the Swiss Alps a height of 4478 m. It is popular for its shape.



4. The North European plain

The north European plain stretches from the Atlantic Ocean in the west to the Ural mountains in the east. On the north, it is surrounded by the Baltic Sea and on the South by the alpine mountain. It is narrow in the West and wide towards the East.

Major European rivers such as the Seine, the Rhine, the Danube and the Don criss-cross this region and deposit their alluvium.

The **Andalusian Plain, The Hungarian Plain** and **the Wallachian Plain** are also found in this region. It has rich deposits of coal and iron ore. The north European plain is densely populated region and cities like **Paris, Moscow** and **Berlin** are located here.

Drainage

The rivers play an important role in the development of Europe. These rivers are used to irrigate farmland and also help to produce electricity.

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